AI-assisted development with VS Code or Cursor

By connecting VS Code or Cursor to the Jetson directly over SSH, you can browse and edit the files of the Jetson from your computer, use the code completion and the extensions, and run the code on the Jetson through the integrated terminal. The code actually runs on the Jetson, while the editor interface runs on your computer.

This article only introduces the SSH remote development configuration of VS Code and Cursor.

1. Prepare the SSH connection

Make sure that the Jetson is powered on and connected to the network, and that you know the user name, the IP address and the password. Check the IP in the Jetson terminal:

```
hostname -I
```

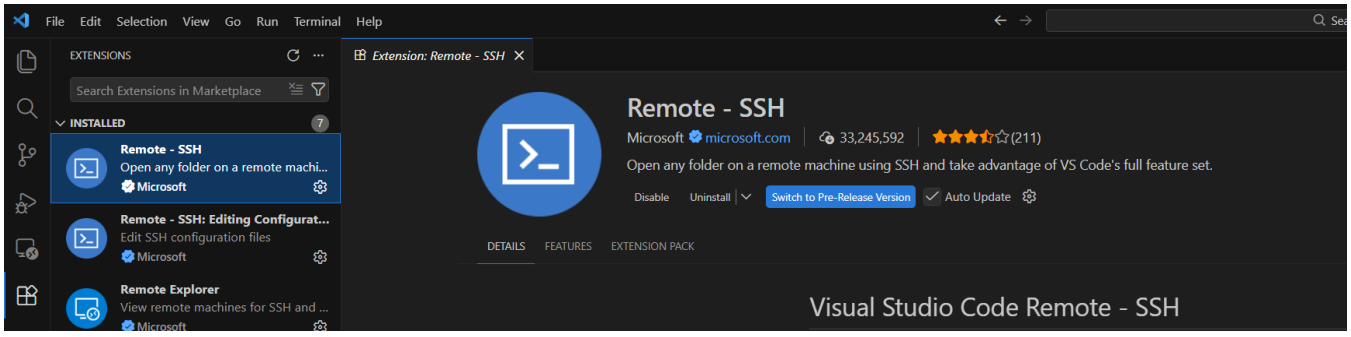
Test the connection in the terminal of your computer:

```
ssh jetson@192.168.2.61
```

Replace the user name and the IP in the example with the actual values.

2. Install the Remote - SSH extension in VS Code

Open VS Code, press Ctrl+Shift+X to open the extension panel, search for Remote - SSH and install the extension published by Microsoft.



3. The remote connection function of Cursor

Cursor usually has Remote - SSH built in, so you do not have to install the extension separately. If the entry point is not shown, press Ctrl+Shift+P to open the command panel and search for Remote-SSH: Connect to Host....

4. Connect to the Jetson

1. Press Ctrl+Shift+P to open the command panel.
2. Select Remote-SSH: Connect to Host....
3. Enter the SSH address, for example:

```
ssh jetson@192.168.2.61
```

The general format can also be used:

```
USERNAME@JETSON_IP
```

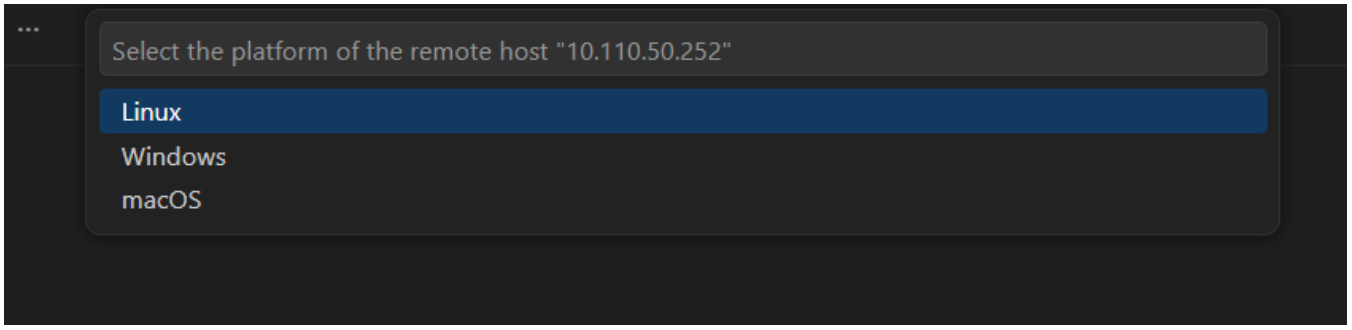
On the first connection, if you are asked to confirm the host fingerprint, make sure the target really is your own Jetson before you continue.

5. Select the remote system

On the first connection, select the platform of the remote host:

```
Linux
```

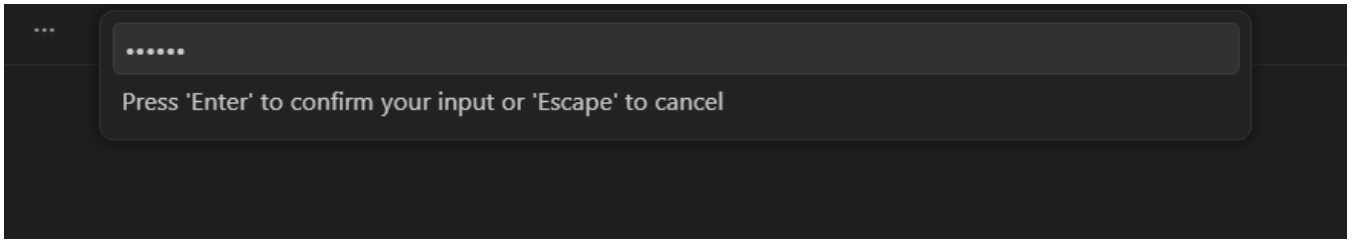
The editor automatically installs the lightweight remote server side on the Jetson.



6. Enter the password and complete the connection

Enter the password of the Jetson user when prompted. After the connection succeeds, the bottom left corner of the window should show something like:

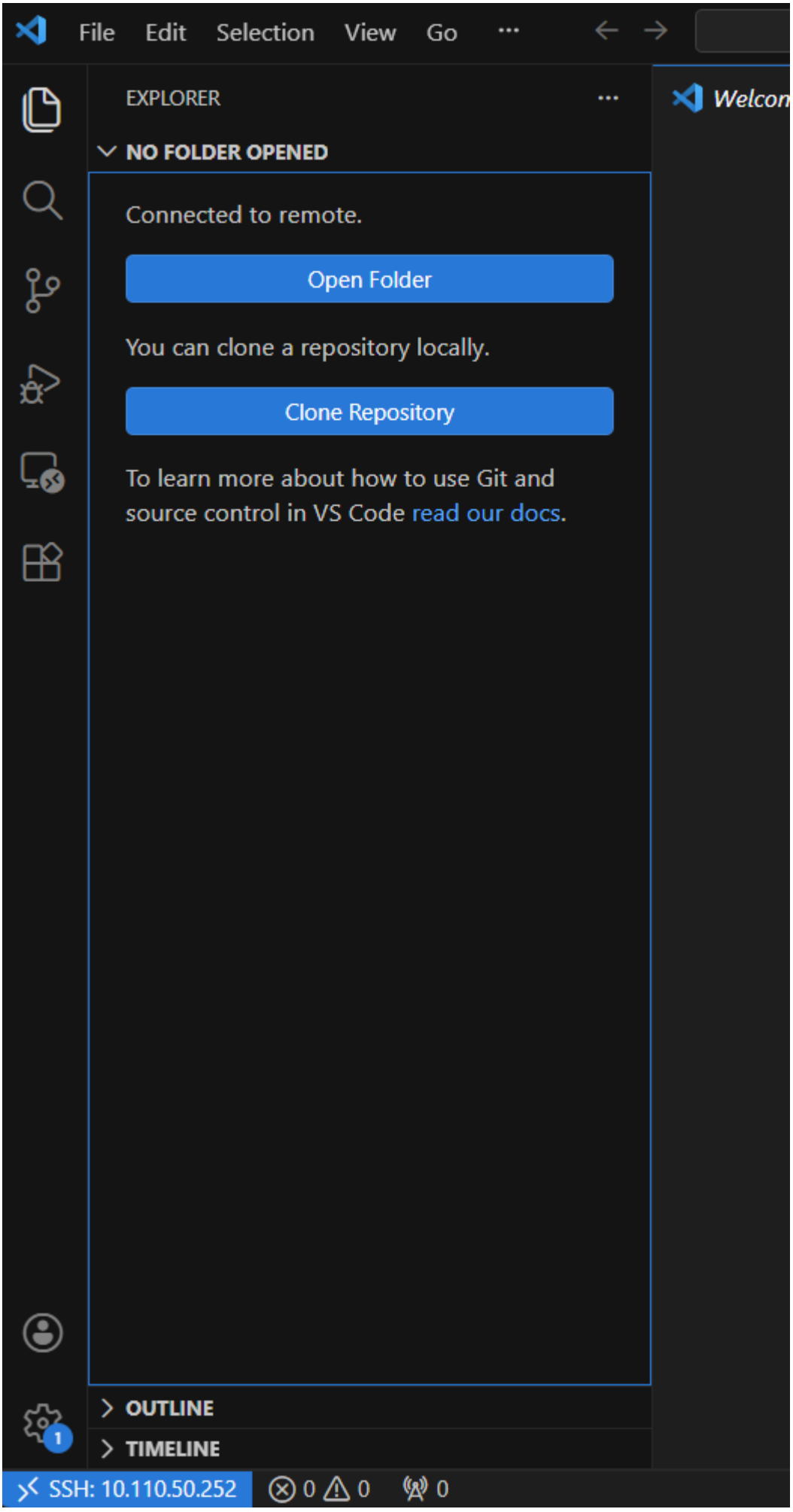
```
SSH: 192.168.2.61
```



7. Open the project directory of the Jetson

Click Open Folder and select the project directory on the Jetson, for example:

```
/home/jetson/voice_to_openclaw
/home/jetson/hardware_hal_demo
/home/jetson/yahboom_ws
/home/jetson/jetson-device-skills
```


File
Edit
Selection
View
Go
EXPLORER
NO FOLDER OPENED
Connected to remote.
Open Folder
You can clone a repository locally.
Clone Repository
To learn more about how to use Git and source control in VS Code read our docs.
OUTLINE
TIMELINE
SSH: 10.110.50.252
0
0
0

The shortcut for opening the integrated terminal is Ctrl+`. The terminal commands are executed on the Jetson, for example:

```
cd /home/jetson/jetson-device-skills
ls
```

8. Save the SSH configuration (optional)

To avoid typing the full IP every time, you can add the following to the SSH configuration file ~/.ssh/config on your computer:

```
Host jetson
    HostName 192.168.2.61
    User jetson
```

After saving it, you can select jetson in the Remote-SSH host list, and you can also run:

```
ssh jetson
```

9. Verify the connection

After the connection succeeds, run the following in the integrated terminal of VS Code or Cursor:

```
hostname
whoami
pwd
ls -la /home/jetson
```

The hostname and the whoami should show the host name and the user of the remote Jetson. The SSH remote connection indicator has to be shown in the bottom left corner of the window.

10. Working together with OpenClaw

After you connect to the Jetson, you can open the following directories:

```
/home/jetson/jetson-device-skills
/home/jetson/.openclaw/workspace
/home/jetson/.openclaw/workspace/skills
```

If the Jetson Device Skills have already been connected, the jetson-* directories in the OpenClaw workspace may be symlinks that point to jetson-device-skills/skills/. The editor can look at the target of the link and at the SKILL.md of each Skill directly.

11. Frequently asked questions

The SSH connection fails

Check the IP of the Jetson, the user name, the password and the network, and run the ssh command again in the terminal of your computer.

Remote-SSH cannot be found

In VS Code install the Remote - SSH extension of Microsoft; Cursor usually already has the function built in.

The terminal that is opened is not the Jetson

Make sure the bottom left corner shows `SSH: <the target IP>` and verify it with hostname. After the remote extension is installed, some of the extensions run on the Jetson, and the related Python and system dependencies follow the Jetson environment.